

Drawing arbitrary shapes with the path class

The Path class enables you to declare any shape based on a set of commands that replicate the features of the Flash drawing API. Its data property is a string that executes cursor placement and drawing operations. The data string alternates commands and sets of numeric values. Each command is notated with a single alphabetical character, as follows:

- ▶ **C** - Draw a cubic Bezier curve. The first two values are the first set of control coordinates, the second two values are the second set of control coordinates, and the last two values are the drawing destination.
- ▶ **H** - Draw a horizontal line from the current cursor coordinate to a new X coordinate.
- ▶ **L** - Draw a line from the current cursor position to a set of coordinates. For example, the command L 100 100 causes a line to be drawn from the current cursor position to X and Y coordinates of 100 and 100.
- ▶ **M** - Move the cursor to a set of coordinates. For example, the command M 50 100 causes the cursor to be placed at an X coordinate of 50 and a Y coordinate of 100.
- ▶ **Q** - Draw a quadratic Bezier curve. The first two values are the control coordinates, and the last two are the drawing destination.
- ▶ **V** - Draw a vertical line from the current cursor coordinate to a new Y coordinate.
- ▶ **Z** - Close the path.



The following simple Path object draws a horizontal line starting at X and Y positions of 100, and then draws a horizontal line to an X position of 500. The colour and weight of the path are determined by its stroke property:

```
<s:Path data="M 100 100 H 500 Z">
  <s:stroke>
    <s:SolidColorStrokecolor="black" weight="5"/>
  </s:stroke>
</s:Path>
```

More complex Path objects can be drawn with more commands, and multiple shapes and lines can be drawn in the same Path object by moving